Structure and Significance of Matthew 8-9

I. Matthew 8-9 is surrounded by two of the five discourses of Jesus in Matthew (ch. 5-7 and ch. 10), so these two chapters naturally go together

II. **What is Matthew 8-9 doing?**
   a. Beginning: 8:1 – "When Jesus came down from the mountain"
      i. Theme: *Jesus with the People*
         1. Alternate titles: *The King with His Subjects*, *The New Moses and the People*
   b. Ending: 9:28 – "Do you believe that I am able to do this?"
      i. Matthew 8-9 deals heavily with stories of healing, faith, and disbelief
      ii. Jesus is the one who can heal us. Some believe that while others do not. Which will we be?

III. **Structure/Overview** – Look for: Healing, Belief, Disbelief, Authority
   a. Leper **healed** (8:1-4)
      i. "If You are willing, You can make me clean" (8:2)
         1. Belief
      ii. "I am willing; be cleansed" (8:3)
      iii. *Healed by touch*
   b. Centurion's servant **healed** (8:5-13)
      i. "I am not worthy" (8:8)
      ii. Acknowledges Jesus' ***authority***
      iii. "Jesus marveled… 'I have not found such great faith with anyone in Israel'" (8:10)
      iv. "It shall be done for you as you have believed" (8:13)
      v. *Healed by words*
   c. Peter's mother-in-law **healed** (8:14-15)
      i. *Healed by touch*
      ii. "She got up and waited on Him" (8:15)
   d. Crowds **healed** (8:16-17)
      i. Jesus healed all who came
      ii. "When evening came" (8:16)
      iii. Isaiah 53:4
   e. Challenge wanna-be disciples (8:18-22)
      i. Scribe
         1. Jesus: Are you sure? I have nowhere to dwell.
      ii. Another person: "Lord, permit me to first go and bury my father" (8:21)
         1. Jesus: "Follow Me, and allow the dead to bury their own dead" (8:22)
      iii. POINT: Following Jesus must come #1

f. Disciples on the sea (8:23-27)
    i. "When He got into the boat, His disciples followed Him" (8:23)
    ii. Great storm; Jesus was asleep
    iii. "Save us, Lord; we are perishing!" (8:25)
        1. "Why are you afraid, you men of little faith?" (8:26)
    iv. Disciples amazed
        1. "What kind of man is this, that even the winds and the sea obey Him?" (8:27)
g. Two demon-possessed men **healed** (8:28-34)
    i. Two demon-possessed men come to Jesus
        1. "What business do we have with each other, ***Son of God***?" (8:29)
    ii. Jesus sends (authority) demons into swine (8:32)
    iii. *Healed by words*
    iv. City (afraid?) comes to Jesus
        1. "They implored Him to leave their region" (8:34) — Bad!
h. Paralytic **healed** (9:1-8)
    i. Men brought Jesus a paralytic
        1. "Seeing their faith" (9:2)
    ii. "Take courage, son; ***your sins are forgiven***" (9:2)
    iii. Scribes think Jesus is blaspheming
        1. Disbelief
        2. Jesus proves them wrong using physical healing
    iv. *Healed by words*
    v. "When the crowds saw this, they were awestruck, and glorified God, who had given such ***authority*** to men" (9:8)
i. Matthew called (9:9)
    i. Jesus called Matthew: "Follow Me!"
    ii. "He got up and followed Him" (9:9)
        1. Point: he showed the willingness to do the difficult thing for Jesus'
j. Jesus, Pharisees, and "the losers" (9:10-13)
    i. Jesus eating with tax collectors and sinners
    ii. Pharisees: "Why is your Teacher eating with the tax collectors and sinners?" (9:11)
    iii. Jesus: "**I came to heal the (physically and spiritually) sick**. You are uncompassionate. **I came to call sinners**"
k. Jesus on fasting (9:14-17)
    i. John's disciples asked Jesus: "Why don't Your disciples fast?"
    ii. Jesus: "Because I am here. When I leave, then they will"
    iii. Discourse on patches and wineskins
l. Little girl and other woman **healed** (9:18-26)

i. "My daughter has just died; but come and lay Your hand on her, and she will live" (9:18)
    1. Belief
ii. Other woman "came up behind Him and touched the fringe of His cloak; for she was saying to herself, 'If I only touch His garment, I will get well" (9:20-21)
    1. Belief
iii. Jesus said to "Other woman": "Daughter, take courage; your faith has made you well.' **At once the woman was made well**" (9:22)
    1. *Healed by touching Jesus*
iv. Jesus arrives at the little girl's house
v. Jesus: "The girl has not died, but is asleep" (9:24)
    1. Point: As far as Jesus is concerned, death is little more than sleep because He has authority to raise the dead
vi. "And they began laughing at Him" (9:24)
    1. Disbelief
vii. Jesus "took her by the hand, and **the girl got up**" (9:25)
    1. *Healed by touch*
viii. Jesus' fame spreads

m. Two blind men **healed** (9:27-31)
    i. Two blind men: "Have mercy on us, Son of David!" (9:27)
    ii. Jesus: "Do you believe that I am able to do this?" (9:28)
        1. ***THE QUESTION OF MATTHEW 8-9***
    iii. Two blind men: "Yes, Lord" (9:28)
    iv. Jesus: "It shall be done to you according to your faith" (9:29)
    v. *Healed by touch*
    vi. Blind men, against Jesus' command, spread the news about Him
n. Mute, Demon-possessed man **healed** along with others (9:32-38)
    i. Jesus cast out the demon in the man
    ii. Crowds (belief?): "Nothing like this has ever been seen in Israel" (9:33)
    iii. Pharisees (disbelief): "He casts out the demons by the ruler of the demons" (9:34)
    iv. Jesus taught and **healed** everywhere He went
    v. "Seeing the people, He felt compassion for them, because they were distressed and dispirited like sheep without a shepherd" (9:36)
        1. Jesus tells His disciples that they need to pray God sends more workers out into the world because it is ripe for harvest…
        2. …Chapter 10: Discourse #2 – sending of the new workers prayed for in 9:37-38!

- o. **POINT**:
  - i. Jesus among the people, healing them
    1. By words and/or touch (Jesus touches them or vice versa)
  - ii. Some are believing; some are disbelieving
  - iii. Jesus sees the people as needing help and guidance
    1. Tells the disciples to pray
    2. Dedicates His second major Discourse in Matthew to prepping and sending them

Structure Graphic

